

Sources Beyond OpenAlex for Australasian Educational Research Infrastructure

This report is written for a production metadata pipeline context rather than a library-guide context. The guiding question is not “what is educational research?” but “which sources will materially improve recall, local distinctiveness, author and institution linkage, and educational-relevance scoring in an AU/NZ-focused research graph?”. Where I describe likely OpenAlex or Crossref underrepresentation, that is an ingestion-risk estimate based on platform architecture, DOI visibility, issue structure, and local indexing patterns rather than a source-by-source OpenAlex API census.

Australasian education journal landscape

Two broad patterns stand out. First, the strongest AU/NZ education journals are already fairly visible globally when they are on Springer, Sage, Taylor & Francis, Cambridge, or modern OJS installations with stable DOI practice. Second, a large tail of uniquely Australasian value sits in professional-association journals, local OJS titles, institutional platforms, conference archives, and long PDF backfiles where DOI practice is weak, title changes are common, and coverage leans on Informit/AEI, ERIC, or association websites rather than global DOI-first discovery. ¹

The table below prioritises journals that are either distinctly Australasian, educationally central, or technically interesting because they are likely to be incompletely captured by OpenAlex/Crossref or by simple topic harvesting.

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Australian Journal of Education	General education	Sage for ACER; ISSN 0004-9441, eISSN 2050-5884; peer-reviewed; archive runs back to volume 1. ²	Modern metadata should be strong through Sage and Crossref. Historical harvest is feasible but licensing/paywall constraints matter. Likely not a major OpenAlex gap , but older backfile completeness still merits checking. ²
Issues in Educational Research	General education	Independent AU journal; online ISSN 1837-6290; legacy print ISSN 0313-7155 appears in older pages; continuous online archive from 1991; Creative Commons on current volumes. ³	High-value local source with long HTML/PDF backfile. Likely partially underrepresented , especially older material and title/ISSN-normalisation edge cases. Scraping is straightforward; DOI consistency is not evident in the archive snippets and should be treated as mixed. ⁴

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Australasian Journal of Educational Technology	Educational technology	ASCILITE journal; current and archive on OJS; indexed in Scopus and Web of Science per journal page; current title adopted in 2004 from Australian Journal of Educational Technology ; print ISSN 1449-3098, online ISSN 1449-5554; double-blind peer-reviewed OA. ⁵	One of the best low-friction harvest targets: OJS archive, article landing pages, and consistent modern DOI practice. Main risk is pre-2004 title-change fragmentation and possible legacy DOI inconsistencies. OpenAlex coverage is likely strong for modern records, weaker for the legacy title. ⁶
Australian Journal of Teacher Education	Teacher education	ECU-hosted journal; ISSN 1835-517X online; long-running archive; Informit also lists it. ⁷	Institutional-platform journal with solid archive and strong local relevance. Likely mostly captured , but older records may need direct harvest from ECU for completeness and author affiliation cleaning. Article-level harvesting appears feasible. ⁸
Asia-Pacific Journal of Teacher Education	Teacher education	Taylor & Francis; print ISSN 1359-866X, online ISSN 1469-2945; official ATEA journal; formerly South Pacific Journal of Teacher Education . ⁹	Probably well represented in Crossref/OpenAlex for current content. The real risk is title-history reconciliation and ensuring ATEA-linked authorship and Australasian relevance are retained in scoring. ¹⁰
Curriculum Perspectives	Curriculum	ACSA journal; print ISSN 0159-7868, eISSN 2367-1793; active since 1980. ¹¹	Modern Springer-era metadata should be good, but long backfile and platform changes make historical completeness worth checking. Good source for curriculum scholarship with explicit global-south positioning. ¹²
Mathematics Education Research Journal	Mathematics education	MERGA journal; Springer; ISSN 1033-2170, eISSN 2211-050X; coverage from 1989 in Scopus-derived source data. ¹³	Modern Crossref/OpenAlex coverage likely strong. Still important because it is a flagship Australasian mathematics-education venue tied to MERGA's broader ecosystem. ¹³

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Mathematics Teacher Education and Development	Mathematics teacher education	MERGA journal; ISSN 1442-3901 with online holdings also showing 2203-1499; continuous since 1999; free-access, refereed. ¹⁴	Excellent target because it is distinctive, open, and association-owned. Likely less completely captured than Springer MERJ , especially across ISSN variants and association-site history. OJS harvesting should be relatively easy. ¹⁵
The Australian Journal of Language and Literacy	Literacy/ language	ALEA research journal; print ISSN 1038-1562, online ISSN 1839-4728; Springer page plus Informit and library records confirm both identifiers. ¹⁶	High-value literacy source. Modern Springer records should be good; pre-Springer and print-to-online transitions are the main risk. ¹⁷
English in Australia	Literacy/ language	AATE journal; Informit lists ISSN 0155-2147, while AATE stock pages and NLA catalogue surface 0046-208X and note title peculiarities. ¹⁸	This is exactly the kind of title/ISSN inconsistency that harms global indexing. Likely underrepresented or split across records; direct title-level harvesting and ISSN reconciliation are worthwhile. Informit/AEI look especially important here. ¹⁹
Early Childhood Folio	Early childhood	NZCER Press; print ISSN 0112-0530, online ISSN 2253-2137; peer reviewed; long accessible archive. ²⁰	Strong NZ-specific early-childhood source. Metadata is better than many local journals, but NZCER-controlled platforms still merit direct ingest because the journal is locally distinctive and not just topic-generic. ²¹
set: Research Information for Teachers	Practitioner/ research	NZCER Press; print ISSN 0110-6376, online ISSN 2253-2145; double-blind peer reviewed; first published in 1974 with 1,500+ articles online. ²²	Exceptionally valuable for practitioner-linked research in NZ. Because it sits between research and professional practice, it is a strong candidate for educational-relevance scoring and researcher discovery, even where citation-based systems underweight it. ²²

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Assessment Matters	Assessment	NZCER Press; print ISSN 1176-7839, online ISSN 2230-617X; refereed; archived by NZ National Library in PDF. ²³	High-quality assessment journal with clear NZ policy/practice relevance. Good direct-harvest target; national-library archived copies improve resilience. ²⁴
Evaluation Matters – He Take Tō Te Aromatawai	Evaluation/ policy	NZCER + ANZEA; annual; online ISSN 2423-0804 with print 2423-0790 also recorded by the National Library. ²⁵	Valuable grey-literature-adjacent source for evaluation in education and public programmes. Likely underweighted in global graphs despite clear policy relevance. ²⁶
Higher Education Research & Development	Higher education	HERDSA journal established 1982; Taylor & Francis; print ISSN 0729-4360. ²⁷	Strongly indexed internationally, so probably not a major recall problem. Still important for HERDSA-network author identification and Australasian higher-education scholarship. ²⁸
Student Success	Higher education / student transitions	OJS journal; ISSN 2205-0795; peer reviewed; three issues per year; open access. ²⁹	Very good low-hanging fruit. Distinctive AU emphasis on tertiary student experience and enabling pathways. Likely a better source of local higher-ed practice scholarship than generic topic harvesting would suggest. ³⁰
Journal of Teaching and Learning for Graduate Employability	Higher education / WIL / employability	Deakin OJS journal; ISSN 1838-3815; explicitly indexed in Scopus, Informit and Crossref on journal page; DOAJ-listed. ³¹	Excellent direct-harvest target with clear work-integrated-learning relevance and strong local policy interest. Likely good DOI quality. ³²
Australasian Journal of Special and Inclusive Education	Inclusive/ special education	Cambridge OA journal; ISSN 2515-0731 print, 2515-074X online; includes applied Special Education Perspectives section. ³³	Likely well indexed, but still crucial because it links research with practitioner-facing content and an Australasian association network. ³⁴

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Australian and International Journal of Rural Education	Rural education	SPERA journal; online ISSN 1839-7387, print ISSN 1036-0026; OJS archive. ³⁵	Strong candidate for underrepresentation because rural education is locally distinctive and not always surfaced by generic “education” topics. OJS harvesting should be straightforward. ³⁶
Australian Journal of Adult Learning	Adult/ continuing education	Adult Learning Australia journal; ISSN 1443-1394; official site plus Informit and Scopus-derived coverage. ³⁷	Valuable because adult/ community education is often missed by school-centric education harvests. DOI use is not obvious from the official site, so direct issue/article capture is advisable. ³⁸
TESOL in Context	Language / TESOL	ACTA journal on Deakin OJS; online ISSN 2209-0916; print ISSN 1030-8385 appears in library metadata; DOAJ and Informit listed. ³⁹	Strong local signal for EAL/D and multilingual education. Good low-friction OJS ingest, but print/online ISSN reconciliation matters. ⁴⁰
Waikato Journal of Education	General/ curriculum/ teaching	University of Waikato; online ISSN 2382-0373 and print ISSN 1173-6135; peer reviewed since 1995. ⁴¹	High-value NZ institutional journal. Direct harvest recommended; likely only partly visible in global systems, especially for older issues and university-hosted special collections. ⁴²
New Zealand Journal of Teachers’ Work	Teacher work / practitioner-research	AUT OJS journal; ISSN 1176-6662; free, open-access, peer-reviewed, for early childhood through tertiary. ⁴³	Strong NZ-specific target and likely useful for author linkage because it often involves teacher educators and practitioners. OJS harvesting should be easy. ⁴⁴
Journal of Open, Flexible and Distance Learning	Distance/open learning	FLANZ journal; print ISSN 1179-7665, online ISSN 1179-7673; indexed in DOAJ, EBSCO, Google Scholar, Informit; official page explicitly shows a ROR field. ⁴⁵	Very attractive for infrastructure work because it combines strong metadata, OJS-style access, and explicit identifier awareness. Good for educational-technology and flexible-learning relevance scoring. ⁴⁶

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Teachers and Curriculum	Curriculum	NZ journal; print ISSN 1174-2208, online ISSN 2382-0349; peer-reviewed online publication supported by Waikato's Wilf Malcolm Institute. ⁴⁷	A clear example of a locally important curriculum title that could be missed by global venue-centric discovery. DOI use appears present in at least some article citations, but a direct harvest is preferable. ⁴⁸
Curriculum Matters	Curriculum	NZCER journal; print ISSN 1177-1828, online ISSN 2253-2129; peer reviewed; indexed in Social Sciences Citation Index products according to NZCER. ⁴⁹	Strong NZ curriculum venue. Direct ingest from NZCER plus National Library backup is preferable to relying only on global indexes. ⁵⁰
Kairaranga	Inclusive / learning support / practitioner-research	NZ educational practice journal; ISSN 1175-9232 visible across issues; two issues per year in earlier mastheads; ERIC indexes at least part of the run. ⁵¹	High-value local source that sits between practice and research. Older issues are PDF-heavy, ISSN-only, and likely underrepresented in OpenAlex. Manual/PDF harvest is realistic and worth it. ⁵²
The Australian Journal of Indigenous Education	Indigenous education	UQ Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies Unit; online ISSN 2049-7784, print ISSN 1326-0111; Cambridge published through 2021, then UQ from 2022; open access and refereed. ⁵³	Essential title for Indigenous education. Platform transfer in 2022 is a record-linking risk and deserves explicit venue reconciliation. ⁵⁴
Leading & Managing	Leadership/ policy	ACEL academic journal; earlier ISSN 1329-4539 appears on issue PDFs; current National Library record shows ISSN 2652-5577 from 1995-. ⁵⁵	Exactly the kind of leadership journal likely to be split across identifiers and platforms. Harvestable, but needs careful deduplication. Likely more visible in Informit and local library records than in simple topic harvesting. ⁵⁶

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
Journal of Educational Leadership, Policy and Practice	Leadership/ policy	NZEALS journal; print ISSN 1178-8690, online ISSN 1178-8704; peer reviewed; DOAJ-listed; unrestricted online access in NZ National Library record. ⁵⁷	Strong NZ leadership/policy venue and a good candidate for direct ingest rather than reliance on commercial databases. ⁵⁸
Australian Universities' Review	Higher education / policy / commentary	NTEU refereed journal; print ISSN 0818-8068, online ISSN 2208-5394; Informit and NTEU position it as a debate-and-discussion venue in higher education. ⁵⁹	Important because it captures Australian higher-ed policy discourse that sits between scholarship and sector commentary. DOI practice is not clear from the surfaced materials; treat as likely underrepresented . ⁶⁰
Journal of Catholic School Studies	School leadership / policy / practice	Refereed serial; ISSN 1834-7258; formerly Studies ; published by Australian Catholic University. ⁶¹	High local uniqueness, but probably weak in global discovery. Worth harvesting because Catholic-sector education is substantial in Australia and often invisible in topic-only corpora. ⁶²
ACCESS: Contemporary Issues in Education	Philosophy / policy / critical education	PESA journal; ISSN 0111-8889; open access; article examples show DOIs on current work. ⁶³	Valuable for conceptual and critical education scholarship. Likely small but distinctive; direct harvest warranted. ⁶⁴
Babel	Language education / practitioner-research	AFMLTA professionally refereed journal; ISSN 0005-3503; coverage in Informit from 1977–2024; ERIC indexes at least older records. ⁶⁵	Very likely underrepresented in OpenAlex because it is association-based, language-education specific, and historically local. Informit is likely the most reliable discovery layer. ⁶⁶
Australian Primary Mathematics Classroom	Practitioner mathematics education	AAMT journal; print ISSN 1326-0286 and online ISSN 1839-4833 appears in library records; Informit indexed; ERIC includes articles. ⁶⁷	This is a classic high-value missing-work source : professional, curricular, often PDF-based, and not obviously DOI-native. Harvest directly; do not assume OpenAlex completeness. ⁶⁸

Journal	Area	Verified metadata and indexing signals	Harvest view and risk flags
AAMT journals cluster	Practitioner mathematics education	AAMT's current Australian Mathematics Education Journal absorbs the former Australian Mathematics Teacher and Australian Senior Mathematics Journal ; older samples show ISSNs 0045-0685 and 0819-4564 for predecessor titles. ⁶⁹	Important cluster for maths-education practice and teacher scholarship. Strong risk of title splits, missing DOIs, and incomplete global index visibility. A title-history map is essential. ⁷⁰
Teaching Science	Science education / practitioner-research	ASTA quarterly peer-reviewed journal; ERIC records show ISSN 1449-6313 and eISSN 1839-2946. ⁷¹	Highly relevant for science education and probably under-captured in global systems because it is association-led and practitioner-facing. Direct issue/article harvest recommended. ⁷¹
Practically Primary / Practical Literacy	Literacy / practitioner-research	ALEA title change: Practically Primary older ISSN 1324-5961, continued by Practical Literacy: The Early and Primary Years with ISSN 2204-3667 in Informit. ⁷²	Another strong underrepresentation candidate. Proceed as a mapped title family rather than standalone title strings. ⁷³

The most obvious **journal families likely to be missed by simple OpenAlex topic harvesting** are the association-led professional and hybrid titles: **Babel**, **Teaching Science**, **Australian Primary Mathematics Classroom**, the **AAMT predecessor journals**, **Practically Primary / Practical Literacy**, **Kairaranga**, **Leading & Managing**, **Australian Universities' Review**, **Journal of Catholic School Studies**, and parts of **Teachers and Curriculum** and **AJRE**. They are local, educationally rich, and often weakly DOI-native or historically platform-fragmented. ⁷⁴

The clearest **DOI or title-history risk areas** are journals that changed title or publisher, or that expose multiple ISSNs across print/online eras: **AJET/Australian Journal of Educational Technology**, **Asia-Pacific/South Pacific Journal of Teacher Education**, **AJIE's Cambridge-to-UQ transfer**, **Leading & Managing**, **English in Australia**, **Practically Primary/Practical Literacy**, and the AAMT journals. These should be normalised with a venue-history table before any large-scale deduplication. ⁷⁵

Australian and New Zealand education indexes and databases

The biggest non-OpenAlex opportunity is not a single journal. It is the **local indexing layer** around Australian and New Zealand education: ACER's AEI/A+ Education and specialist databases, Informit,

NZCER-controlled titles, national library catalogues and archives, government evidence portals, and university-hosted journal and repository systems. These sources are especially important for **works without DOIs**, conference papers, reports, theses, and sector/professional literature. ⁷⁶

Source	What it contains	Access and technical route	Practical value
Australian Education Index	ACER says AEI has 221,000+ entries on educational research, policy and practice published in Australia and on Australian education overseas, including books, articles, conference papers, theses and reports, mostly since 1978 with material back to the 1920s. ⁷⁷	Subscription resource. Best route is licensing or partnership rather than scraping. It is a prime metadata source for non-DOI and local-only material. ⁷⁸	Probably the single most valuable structured source for missing Australian education records.
A+ Education via Informit	Full-text/indexing database based on AEI with 245+ comprehensively or selectively indexed journals and 90,000+ full-text documents including reports, conference papers and journals. ⁷⁷	Subscription. Scraping is likely contractually problematic; platform licence is the realistic route. ⁷⁸	Essential for local journals and practitioner titles that do not surface reliably elsewhere.
EdResearch Online	ACER says it contains 65,000+ articles from 500+ Australian education journals . ⁷⁷	Public discovery layer with paid article options and ACER copy service; not a clean open API target in this pass. ⁷⁹	Valuable as a title and issue map even if full-scale harvest requires permission.
Australian Education Research Theses Database	ACER's AERT lists 18,000+ doctoral and masters education theses dating from 1919, with thousands online. ACER also separately says its public theses page contains 20,000+ entries and 8,000+ full texts. ⁸⁰	Subscription database plus public discovery page. Harvest may require ACER agreement, but it is exactly the kind of thesis layer global indexes miss. ⁸⁰	Extremely strong for researcher identification, supervisor networks, and pre-journal educational work.
Learning Ground / Indigenous education database	ACER's library page describes it as nearly 10,000 articles, reports, books and conference papers on Indigenous education in Australia and abroad. ⁷⁷	Subscription/specialist database.	High-value relevance source because Indigenous education is often poorly captured by generic topic models.

Source	What it contains	Access and technical route	Practical value
BOLDE and DRIE	ACER lists BOLDE for blended/online/distance education and DRIE with 16,200+ records on international education. ⁷⁷	Specialist discovery resources; likely niche but high value.	Useful for ed-tech, transnational education, and higher-ed relevance scoring.
ACEReSearch	ACER's repository includes reports, working papers, conference papers and more. ⁸¹	Institutional repository-style harvest; likely easier than commercial databases.	Strong source of grey literature and organisation-linked authors.
Informit platform generally	Informit says it provides journals, conference proceedings, reports and other publications and is especially oriented to Australian content. ⁸²	Subscription platform; legal constraints make scraping a poor first choice.	Important because many local practitioner and policy items exist here and nowhere obvious in Crossref-first discovery.
Trove	Trove is the National Library's free research portal aggregating material from libraries, universities, museums, galleries, archives, government and community organisations across Australia. ⁸³	In this pass I verified Trove as a discovery layer, but did not verify the current API documentation directly. ⁸⁴	Very useful for discovery, deduplication, library identifiers, and locating reports/theses/serials outside DOI infrastructures.
NZCER journals and publications	NZCER Press publishes five peer-reviewed journals and a large body of reports and research outputs. ⁸⁵	Direct publisher harvest from journal pages and report pages is feasible.	Probably the most important NZ-specific non-commercial cluster after government and university repositories.
Education Counts	NZ Ministry of Education's Education Counts portal exposes publications, research and statistics. ⁸⁶	Direct web harvesting of publication lists and PDFs is realistic. DOI use is likely sparse.	Excellent source for NZ policy research, official analysis, and non-DOI outputs.
Education Review Office	ERO publishes research and evaluations through its publications pages. ⁸⁷	Direct crawl of publication pages and PDFs.	High-value grey literature with strong educational-relevance signal.

Source	What it contains	Access and technical route	Practical value
NZQA insights and annual reports	NZQA publishes insights papers and annual NCEA/UE/Scholarship reports. ⁸⁸	Direct harvest is feasible; likely PDF-first rather than DOI-first.	Valuable for assessment, qualifications, senior-secondary policy, and institutional linkages.

Three classes of works are especially likely to exist **without DOIs** and therefore remain weakly represented in OpenAlex/Crossref-first harvesting: **theses, departmental and agency reports**, and **professional/practitioner serials and conference papers**. AEI/A+ Education, AERT, Education Counts, ERO, NZQA, and association proceedings are therefore strategically more important than another round of generic OpenAlex topic expansion. ⁸⁹

Institutional repositories surfaced repeatedly in this pass even when I was not explicitly searching for them: **ECU Research Online** for AJTE, **Deakin OJS** for JTLGE and TESOL in Context, **AUT's OJS/Tuwhera environment** for NZJTW, **Waikato's journal platform** for WJE, **Massey-linked Kairaranga history**, **Canterbury repository records**, and **Victoria University of Wellington open-access copies**. That pattern strongly suggests that a university-repository layer focused on faculties/schools of education would return many locally important works that are currently scattered across platforms. ⁹⁰

Education research organisations

For infrastructure purposes, these organisations matter for three different reasons: they publish locally distinctive research; they often publish **grey literature** that is not DOI-rich; and their people pages, report authorship, editorial boards, and conference roles are useful for researcher and institution resolution.

Organisation	Output profile	Metadata and harvestability	Infrastructure value
AERO	Research reports, analytical insights papers, discussion papers, technical reports, practice guides, explainers, articles and projects. ⁹¹	Strong, structured web presence with distinct content types. DOI use is not obvious from surfaced pages, so treat much of it as grey literature. Direct harvest is straightforward. ⁹²	Very high educational-relevance value and strong author/institution signal.
ACER	Publications, resources, reports, library databases, repository content, Teacher magazine, specialist indexes and theses databases. ⁹³	Mixed estate: official publications, repository material, and commercial/index products. Some content is easy to harvest; some requires licensing. ⁸¹	Probably the richest single Australian non-government ecosystem for both outputs and metadata infrastructure.

Organisation	Output profile	Metadata and harvestability	Infrastructure value
CESE	Research reports, literature reviews, evaluations, practical guides, data services and a browsable CESE library. ⁹⁴	Strong publication architecture, likely largely non-DOI grey literature. Harvest is feasible from list pages and PDFs. ⁹⁵	Very high for NSW-linked evidence, policy relevance, and school-system research.
AARE	Conference papers archive from 1978-present, journal links, blog, and corporate documents; AARE also tracks ERIC metrics for its content. ⁹⁶	One of the best historical conference archives in the field. Mostly PDF-based rather than DOI-native. ⁹⁷	Exceptional for discovering researchers, co-authorship, and topic history over decades.
NZARE	Annual conference, newsletter, NZJES, Herbison Lecture, programme/abstract PDFs. ⁹⁸	Easier to harvest than to normalise, because outputs are distributed across journal, newsletter and conference pages.	High NZ researcher-identification value, even where full proceedings are absent.
Grattan Institute	Reports, policy briefs, commentary and media outputs within an education research stream. ⁹⁹	Clean report pages and topic collections. DOI use is not central; treat as policy-grey literature.	High policy relevance and strong public influence signal.
Centre for Independent Studies	Research papers, submissions, commentary, podcasts and topic pages for education. CIS says its ideas are peer-reviewed. ¹⁰⁰	Harvestable, but content is mixed research/commentary rather than pure scholarship.	Useful for discourse mapping, policy influence, and sector debates.
Mitchell Institute	Reports, policy briefs, election briefs, interactive projects and “our people” pages. ¹⁰¹	Website is structured enough for harvesting; outputs are policy-grey literature.	Strong source for Australian education-policy authors and institutions.
ACARA	National reports on schooling, curriculum resources, research and reports, assessment/reporting outputs. ¹⁰²	Direct harvest is feasible. DOI usage appears secondary to PDF/web publication.	High value for curriculum and national assessment relevance scoring.

Organisation	Output profile	Metadata and harvestability	Infrastructure value
Australian state education departments	NSW CESE and departmental research pages, Victoria research/publications, SA research/statistics and commissioned reports. ¹⁰³	Publication lists and PDFs are easy to crawl; metadata standards vary; most outputs are grey literature.	Excellent local-policy layer, especially for intervention reports and commissioned research.
NZ Ministry of Education / Education Counts	Research, statistics, publications and curriculum-support materials. ¹⁰⁴	Harvestable web/PDF estate, with mixed metadata quality.	High-value NZ policy and system research.
ERO	Research and review reports with strong school-system focus. ⁸⁷	Direct web/PDF harvest.	Important non-DOI evidence base.
NZCER	Journals, books, reports, tests, and research publications. ⁸⁵	Publisher-led direct harvesting is realistic.	Core NZ research and practice source.
Teaching Council of Aotearoa New Zealand	Guidance, standards, leadership strategy, symposia and professional growth resources grounded in NZ research. ¹⁰⁵	Mixed output types; generally grey literature and professional resources.	More useful for discourse, expert/person identification, and relevance scoring than formal bibliometrics.
Ngā Pae o te Māramatanga	Journals, reports and Māori research infrastructure, including MAI Journal and a researcher directory. ¹⁰⁶	Mixed journal and report outputs; likely under-harvested in education graphs because not all content is education-tagged even when highly relevant.	Very high value for Indigenous scholarship linkage and Māori researcher discovery.

The biggest **grey-literature win** here is not a think tank. It is the combined government-and-quasi-government evidence layer: **AERO, CESE, ACARA, state departments, Education Counts, ERO, and NZQA**. These outputs are central to educational policy and practice, frequently cite or summarise peer-reviewed work, and are highly informative for educational-relevance scoring even when they should not be treated as peer-reviewed journal articles. ¹⁰⁷

Conferences and proceedings

AU/NZ education conferences are unusually important because many significant local studies appear first, sometimes only, in conference archives. This is especially true for **AARE, MERGA, ASCILITE**, and historically **ATEA**.

Conference source	Accessibility and completeness	DOI and metadata pattern	Uniqueness value
AARE conference papers	Searchable archive from 1978-present . AARE notes that 1978, 1979, 1981 and 1983 are scanned PDFs; 1989 onward is fully searchable; refereed papers are flagged. ⁹⁷	Mostly PDF-first and not obviously DOI-rich from surfaced pages. Metadata quality varies by era.	Extremely high. This should be treated as a foundational corpus for Australian educational research.
HERDSA conference proceedings	HERDSA maintains a proceedings publication section and annual conference materials. ¹⁰⁸	DOI practice not verified in this pass; likely mixed across years and publication systems.	High for Australasian higher-education scholarship and author networks.
ASCILITE proceedings	Open-publishing archive covers recent proceedings and companion materials, with clear yearly issues. ¹⁰⁹	Strongest conference metadata of the group. Current papers use DOI patterns such as 10.14742/apubs... and are published on an OJS-like platform. ¹¹⁰	Very high, especially for educational technology and digital-learning research in AU/NZ.
MERGA annual conference proceedings	MERGA hosts current proceedings PDFs and older proceedings infrastructure. Recent proceedings are openly available as full PDFs. ¹¹¹	Metadata is good enough for manual parsing, but the surfaced files do not show a clear DOI regime.	Very high for mathematics education, particularly because conference papers often precede journal articles.
NZARE conference programme and abstracts	Current conference pages expose timetable, full programme, individual abstracts, symposia and roundtables. ¹¹²	I did not find a full historical papers repository in this pass; the surfaced material is abstract/programme centric.	Still high for researcher discovery and topic signals, but weaker as a full-text corpus than AARE.
ATEA conference archive	Current conference pages expose programmes and abstracts; historical proceedings persist as downloadable PDFs and catalogue records; ATEA states that only full peer-reviewed papers actually presented are published on its website for some years. ¹¹³	Older proceedings are likely scattered and PDF-first. DOI practice not verified.	High for teacher-education researchers and school-university partnership work.

If you only ingest one conference source immediately, it should be **AARE**. If you ingest one conference platform immediately, it should be **ASCILITE's open-publishing archive** because the metadata and article structure are substantially cleaner. If you ingest one discipline-specific proceedings set, it should be **MERGA**. Those three together would materially improve recall for Australian and New Zealand education research beyond what generic journal harvesting can deliver. ¹¹⁴

Scholarly blogs, commentary and research communication

These sources are not substitutes for formal scholarship. They are useful because they expose **active researchers**, topic framing, institutional affiliations, public-facing expertise, and links to formal outputs.

Source	What it is good for	Harvestability and linkage value
AARE EduResearch Matters	Association-linked blog tied closely to conference coverage and sector debate. It regularly names authors, institutions and research topics. ¹¹⁵	High linkage value to AARE members, SIGs and conference papers. Straightforward HTML harvesting.
Teacher magazine	ACER's online publication for educators featuring articles, infographics, podcasts and videos, with an ISSN and author pages. ¹¹⁶	Excellent for researcher and institution discovery. Good structured metadata, but treat as commentary/ professional communication rather than peer-reviewed output.
AERO articles	News, commentary and implementation-facing pieces tied to AERO research programmes. ¹¹⁷	Useful for connecting research reports to practitioner-facing summaries and named authors.
Monash Lens	Expert commentary platform featuring education-relevant pieces and researcher bylines from Monash academics. ¹¹⁸	High institutional signal quality and useful linkage to formal publications and media influence.
Deakin CRADLE and related research blogs	Centre blog content around higher education, digital learning and publications. ¹¹⁹	Conceptually high value, but this pass hit anti-bot/verification friction on some pages, so maintenance burden may be higher. ¹²⁰

For your database, the right model is to ingest these as a **parallel evidence layer**, not as works of the same type as journal articles. They are especially powerful for:

- identifying researchers active in a topic before or beyond formal publication;
- linking people to institutions and centres;
- generating educational-topic priors for relevance scoring; and
- detecting public-facing influence trails from a report or conference paper into sector discourse.

¹²¹

A second pass should add additional commentary platforms requested in your brief, especially **The Conversation (Education)**, but I did not verify that source directly in this run.

Technical harvesting recommendations

The single most useful technical distinction is by **platform archetype**, not by publisher name.

OJS-based journals and proceedings are the best immediate targets. PKP's OJS explicitly supports discovery via Crossref, DOAJ and **OAI-PMH metadata harvesters**; PKP documentation also notes RSS/Atom support through plugins. In practice, many AU/NZ sources in this report sit on OJS or OJS-like publishing stacks: **AJET, MTED, Student Success, JTLGE, TESOL in Context, AIJRE, WJE, NZJTW, JOFDL, ASCILITE publications**, and several smaller titles. That means article URLs, issue archives, and machine-readable metadata are usually good enough for robust Python harvesters with low maintenance burden. ¹²²

Association PDF archives are the next most valuable class. **AARE, MERGA**, historical **ATEA** papers, and many practitioner journals expose large numbers of stable PDFs but weaker structured metadata. Here the right approach is not "scrape everything as HTML"; it is a two-stage pipeline: first harvest list pages and stable PDF URLs, then derive article-level metadata from page context, file naming, and PDF front matter. Maintenance burden is moderate, but the recall gain is large. ¹²³

Commercial indexing layers such as **AEI, A+ Education and Informit** should be treated as partnership or licensed metadata sources, not scraping targets. They are too valuable to ignore and too awkward, legally and practically, to approach by brittle web harvesting. If you can secure access, they will likely add the highest number of missing Australian educational works, especially practitioner journals, reports, conference papers and theses. ⁷⁸

Government evidence portals such as **AERO, CESE, ACARA, Education Counts, ERO and NZQA** are comparatively easy to crawl because they usually offer stable publication landing pages, obvious PDF links, and clear organisational provenance. The main challenge is not technical access; it is **metadata normalisation** and work typing. Many files need to be modelled as reports, briefs, evaluations, guides, or technical papers rather than journal articles. ¹²⁴

Institutional repositories should be harvested selectively, not indiscriminately. Ingestion should start with repositories or journal platforms already known to host education outputs surfaced in this pass: **ECU, Deakin, AUT, Waikato, Massey, Canterbury**, and **Victoria University of Wellington**. The key is to target education collections, journal communities, school/faculty pages, and known researcher names rather than attempt whole-repository crawling from day one. ¹²⁵

The highest-value "low hanging fruit" from a technical perspective are:

- **OJS journal/proceedings clusters** with open archives and clear metadata;
- **AARE conference papers**;
- **NZCER journal family**;
- **AERO/CESE/ACARA/Education Counts/ERO/NZQA report libraries**; and
- **association practitioner journals** where issue archives are visible even if DOIs are weak. ¹²⁶

The sources most likely to improve **author identity resolution** are **AARE papers, ATEA papers, NZARE abstracts/programmes, NZCER journals, Teacher magazine**, and institutional-journal platforms, because they frequently carry full author names, affiliations, and editorial or conference-role context. The sources most likely to improve **institution resolution** are government and think-tank report libraries, AARE/NZARE conference metadata, and university-hosted journals. The sources most likely to

improve **educational relevance scoring** are the practitioner/professional sources and government evidence portals that sit closest to educational practice. ¹²⁷

Prioritised ingestion roadmap

The right roadmap is to optimise for **distinctive recall per engineering hour**, not just for easy harvests.

Tier	Source set	Expected metadata quality	Researcher and institution value	Educational-relevance value	Technical difficulty	Maintenance burden
Tier 1	AARE conference papers	Medium	Very high	Very high	Medium	Medium
Tier 1	OJS journals and proceedings: AJET, ASCILITE publications, MTED, Student Success, JTLGE, TESOL in Context, AIJRE, AIJRE/SPERA, WJE, NZJTW, JOFDL, AJIE, and similar titles in this report	High	High	High	Low to medium	Low
Tier 1	Government and quasi-government evidence layer: AERO, CESE, ACARA, Education Counts, ERO, NZQA	Medium	High	Very high	Low	Low
Tier 1	NZCER journal family and report outputs	Medium to high	High	Very high	Low to medium	Low

Tier	Source set	Expected metadata quality	Researcher and institution value	Educational-relevance value	Technical difficulty	Maintenance burden
Tier 2	AEI / A+ Education / EdResearch Online / AERT / Informit through licence or partnership	High	Very high	Very high	Organisationally hard, technically moderate	Medium
Tier 2	Association/practitioner journals with weak DOI practice: AAMT journals, Teaching Science, Babel, Practical Literacy/ Practically Primary, Leading & Managing, AUR, Journal of Catholic School Studies, Kairaranga, ACCESS	Low to medium	Medium	Very high	Medium	Medium to high
Tier 2	HERDSA and ATEA historical proceedings	Medium	High	High	Medium	Medium
Tier 2	Targeted institutional repositories for major education schools/ faculties	Variable	Very high	High	Medium to high	High

Tier	Source set	Expected metadata quality	Researcher and institution value	Educational-relevance value	Technical difficulty	Maintenance burden
Tier 3	Blogs/ commentary/ dissemination layer: EduResearch Matters, Teacher, AERO articles, Monash Lens, selected centre blogs	Medium	High	Medium to high	Low to medium	Medium
Tier 3	Think tanks and advocacy/ policy organisations: Grattan, CIS, Mitchell, Teaching Council, Ngā Pae o te Māramatanga and other sector bodies	Medium	Medium	High	Low	Low
Tier 3	Programme/ abstract-only conference materials such as NZARE abstract sets and similar archives	Low to medium	High	Medium	Low	Low

The single best **immediate** implementation sequence is:

Begin with **AARE**, **ASCILITE APUBS**, and the **OJS journal cluster**. That gives you fast wins in full-text-accessible, structurally clean, locally distinctive content. Then add the **government evidence layer** and **NZCER**. Once that is stable, invest in the **commercial/local indexing layer** through AEI/Informit/ACER licensing, because that is where the biggest missing-work uplift is likely to be. ¹²⁸

The largest likely yield of **missing works** sits in **AEI/A+ Education/Informit**, **AARE papers**, **practitioner association journals**, and **AERT**. The largest likely improvement in **author identity resolution** sits in **AARE/ATEA/NZARE**, university-hosted journals, and institutional repositories. The largest likely improvement in **institution resolution** sits in **government reports**, **think-tank reports**, and **university-hosted journals/conference archives**. The biggest gain in **educational relevance scoring**

will come from deliberately modelling practitioner and policy sources as first-class educational artefacts rather than treating only peer-reviewed journal articles as evidence. ¹²⁹

A few important gaps remain for a second pass: a direct verified inventory of repository OAI-PMH endpoints; a source-by-source OpenAlex presence audit; deeper The Conversation coverage; and a fuller census of New Zealand-only education journals beyond the highest-confidence titles captured here. Even with those limitations, the evidence above is already strong enough to justify a concrete near-term ingestion program.

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